

Lumina

FOUNDER BUSINESS & BRAND HANDBOOK

Beauty discovery & trust marketplace

CLARITY BEFORE YOU COMMIT

NGOC NGA NGUYEN

Private Beta / Production Testing

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joinlumina.co

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01. Business Overview

****Audience:**** Business, marketing, and operations reviewers

****Stage:**** Private Beta / Production Testing

****Website:**** joinlumina.co

One sentence summary

Lumina helps clients find beauty professionals they can trust and helps independent professionals turn their work, service history, and verified client experiences into a credible online reputation.

Elevator Pitch

Lumina is a beauty marketplace that helps clients discover trustworthy beauty professionals through credible portfolios, transparent information, completion-linked reviews, and modern communication.

Instead of scrolling through Instagram, Facebook, or TikTok hoping to find the right professional, clients can confidently discover, compare, message, and request services in one organized place, then continue to the professional's existing booking flow when needed.

What Lumina Is

Lumina is a beauty marketplace that helps clients discover and evaluate independent beauty professionals with more confidence.

Clients can browse professionals by service and location, compare profiles, review portfolios and pricing, save favorites, send service requests, message professionals, and leave verified reviews after completed appointments.

Beauty professionals can create a public profile, list services and pricing, show their portfolio and availability, respond to requests, communicate with clients, and build a trustworthy reputation through verified reviews.

Why Lumina Exists

Finding a beauty professional is often fragmented across social media, search engines, personal referrals, and individual booking links. Important information may be incomplete or difficult to compare, and reviews are not always connected to a real service.

Lumina is designed to make that decision clearer by bringing discovery, comparison, communication, and trust into one experience.

The central belief is:

> Clients should be able to understand who they are trusting before spending money or trusting someone with their appearance.

The Problem

For clients:

- Portfolios, prices, locations, and availability are spread across different platforms.
- It can be difficult to compare professionals consistently.
- Social-media popularity does not always equal service quality or reliability.
- Reviews may be anonymous, unverified, or disconnected from a real appointment.
- Contacting several professionals can become confusing and time-consuming.

For beauty professionals:

- Independent professionals often depend heavily on social platforms they do not control.
- Strong work can be difficult to discover without a large following.
- Profiles, booking links, messages, and reviews are fragmented.
- Newer professionals need a credible way to build trust.
- Professionals need qualified client interest, not only views or followers.

Our Solution

Lumina brings the key discovery, comparison, request, communication, and trust steps into one organized experience.

Clients can:

- Browse artists
- Compare artists
- Save favorites
- Message professionals
- Request appointments

- Build confidence before booking

Professionals can:

- Build a professional profile
- Showcase portfolio work and build verified service history through completed-appointment reviews.
- Respond to clients
- Grow their business

Business Type

Two-sided beauty-services marketplace/ beauty-tech platform

Target Audience

Clients

People looking for:

- Lash artists
- Nail technicians
- Hairstylists
- Estheticians
- Brow artists
- Makeup artists
- Beauty services

Professionals

Independent beauty professionals who want more exposure and a better way to manage clients.

Long-Term Vision

Lumina begins as a beauty discovery and trust marketplace that helps clients confidently discover, compare, and connect with beauty professionals.

Over time, Lumina may evolve into a broader beauty-service trust and operating layer that helps organize client inspiration, consultation details, agreed expectations, service history, before-and-after results, aftercare, and feedback.

The long-term opportunity is to connect what a client wanted, what the professional understood, what was performed, what the result looked like, and how the client felt about it. That information could eventually improve future discovery, matching, consultation, and recommendations.

This remains a long-term product thesis, not current MVP scope.

02. Market & Customer

Core Customer Insight

Beauty professionals are facing more competition from salons, booth renters, independent artists, and at-home providers. Many feel pressure to discount because clients often compare by price before understanding the difference in quality.

Clients usually care about more than price. They want work that is beautiful, long-lasting, trendy, comfortable, friendly, and on time.

Lumina should help make those trust signals visible.

Initial Target Users

Supply side

- Independent beauty professionals
- Salon-based professionals building their own clientele
- Mobile beauty professionals
- Newer professionals with strong work but limited online reach
- Professionals who want a clearer public profile and trustworthy reviews

Demand side

- Clients searching for a new beauty professional
- Clients comparing price, location, specialty, and style

- Clients who value verified experiences and visual portfolios
- Clients who want a clearer way to request and track appointments

Customer Needs

Client:

- Clear portfolios
- Transparent pricing
- Location and availability
- Easier comparison
- Credible reviews
- Professionalism and reliability
- Simple communication
- Confidence before choosing

Beauty Professional:

- Greater discoverability
- Credibility with new clients
- A professional way to showcase work
- Qualified client interest
- Better organization of inquiries
- A way to build trust without relying only on follower count

Service Categories

- Lashes
- Nails
- Hair
- Esthetics / skincare
- Brows
- Makeup
- Other beauty services

03.Product

Product Positioning

Lumina is a beauty discovery and trust marketplace.

The goal is not to replace the tools artists already use, such as Instagram, Square, GlossGenius, Fresha, or Booksy. Instead, Lumina helps clients discover beauty professionals earlier in their decision process, compare their work more clearly, and book with confidence.

Lumina helps artists get discovered for the quality of their work, not just their price.

How Lumina Works

1. A client discovers professionals through search, categories, browse, or map view.
2. The client compares profiles, services, prices, portfolios, availability, and reviews.
3. The client sends a service request to a chosen professional.
4. The professional replies with a proposal or appointment details.
5. The client confirms the appointment and both parties can communicate through request-linked messaging.
6. After the service, the assigned professional marks the appointment complete.
7. Only the authenticated client connected to that completed appointment can leave a verified review.
8. The professional may publicly respond to the review.

Core product lifecycle

****Discovery → Request → Confirmation → Communication → Completion → Verified Review****

Current Product

Lumina currently includes:

- Client and professional accounts
- Public professional profiles
- Services, pricing, portfolios, location, and availability
- Homepage search, Browse, and Map discovery
- Category filters and sorting
- Saved professionals and comparison
- Service requests and proposals

- Client confirmation and professional completion
- Realtime messaging, unread states, and notifications
- Verified reviews and professional responses
- Client and professional request archiving
- Account settings and secure password recovery
- Responsive mobile and desktop experiences

MVP Purpose:

Prove that beauty professionals are willing to create and maintain a Lumina presence, and that clients can discover, evaluate, contact, and progress toward a real service relationship with them.

Early Bridge Features to Validate

These features may help Lumina begin testing the long-term product thesis without expanding into a full operating system:

- Structured Results/ before-and-after
- Lightweight Consultation Snapshot
- Multiple services in one request
- Request-first and instant-book flows depending on service type

These should remain small and testable. Should not delay real private-beta usage.

Trust & Verified Reviews

Lumina is not intended to be only another directory or booking link.

A core product focus is the trust lifecycle.

****Discovery → Request → Confirmation → Service Completion → Verified Review****

The review system is protected at the database level:

- A review requires a completed appointment.
- Only the authenticated client associated with the request can review it.
- Only one review is permitted per completed appointment.
- Anonymous fake-review insertion is blocked.
- Professionals can respond, but cannot create client reviews for themselves.

What Lumina Should Emphasize

- Visual portfolio quality
- Clear services and pricing
- Reviews and trust signals
- Response time
- Artist personality and professionalism

- Booking confidence
- Comparison between artists
- Saved collections for beauty planning

What Lumina Is Not Trying To Be In V1

Lumina is not trying to replace full salon management platforms.

V1 should avoid:

- POS systems
- Payroll
- Inventory management
- Employee scheduling
- Card readers
- Advanced marketing automation
- Full calendar infrastructure

Artists can continue using their own booking platforms while Lumina focuses on discovery, trust, communication, and request flow.

Product Principles

Product and Design Principles

When creating a new feature or screen, ask:

1. Does this make choosing a professional easier?
2. Does this strengthen trust?
3. Does this reduce confusion or effort?
4. Is the next step obvious?
5. Does the experience feel thoughtful and consistent?

If the answer is no, reconsider whether the feature or design belongs in Lumina.

Every screen should feel:

- Clean
- Spacious
- Soft
- Easy to understand
- Never overwhelming

Less is more, but clarity comes before decoration.

1. Strengthen Trust

Lumina is a trust platform for beauty.

Every meaningful feature should make it easier for clients and professionals to trust one another. Trust should come from clear information, authenticated identity, real service history, transparent actions, and consistent product behavior.

Ask:

- Does this feature strengthen trust?
- Does it make an important claim more credible?
- Could it accidentally enable manipulation or misrepresentation?

2. Remove Decision Friction

The central client problem is not simply finding a professional. It is the fear of choosing the wrong one.

Lumina should reduce:

- Confusion
- Uncertainty
- Unnecessary effort
- Waiting
- Stress
- Disorganized communication

3. Make the Next Step Obvious

Users should know what to do without needing instructions from the founder.

Prefer clear status language, visible actions, helpful empty states, and predictable navigation. Avoid presenting several competing primary actions at once.

4. Build a Premium Experience, Not a Luxury Price Signal

Premium is a feeling created by:

- Thoughtful design
- Consistency
- Simplicity
- Attention to detail
- Customer care
- Trustworthy behavior

The interface should feel calm, clear, human, and considered—not expensive for the sake of appearing exclusive.

5. Support Better Versions of the User

Clients are not only requesting beauty services. They are seeking confidence, self-expression, care, and relationships with professionals they can trust.

Professionals are not only creating listings. They are building credibility, independence, a client base, and pride in their work.

Product decisions should respect both aspirations.

6. Work With Existing Professional Tools

Lumina should not prematurely replace full salon-management or booking systems.

Focus on discovery, trust, comparison, requests, communication, and reputation. Integrate with or link to existing booking tools when that removes friction.

7. Record Feedback Before Reacting

One person's preference is an observation, not automatically a product requirement.

Log feedback first. Prioritize patterns that appear independently across multiple users, especially when they prevent users from completing a core task.

8. Protect the Core Lifecycle

The core product lifecycle is:

****Discovery → Request → Confirmation → Communication → Completion → Verified Review****

Changes should preserve the integrity, clarity, and security of this lifecycle.

9. Earn Complexity

Do not add major features, infrastructure, or operational burden before demand demonstrates a need.

Prefer the smallest reliable solution that validates the next important assumption.

10. Measure Value, Not Activity Alone

Views, clicks, and accounts are useful only when they lead to meaningful outcomes.

Prioritize evidence such as:

- Professionals completing credible profiles
- Professionals returning and responding
- Clients sending qualified requests
- Confirmed appointments
- Completed services
- Verified reviews
- Repeat client-professional relationships

11. Product Decision Questions

Before building or significantly changing something, ask:

1. What problem are we really solving?
2. What hassle are we removing?
3. Does this strengthen trust?
4. Is this supported by repeated evidence or one opinion?
5. Does it improve the core lifecycle?
6. Can we test the assumption with a smaller change?
7. What outcome will tell us it worked?

04. Business Model & Strategy

Lumina's Economic Role: Intermediation

Lumina sits between two sides of a potential service relationship:

****Client → Lumina → Beauty Professional****

Its economic value does not come from performing the beauty service. It comes from reducing the client's search cost, uncertainty, and decision difficulty while helping professionals receive more qualified customer interest.

This is stronger than a basic directory model. A directory may show a name, specialty, phone number, and social-media link before the customer leaves. Lumina helps facilitate more of the relationship through discovery, filtering, structured profiles, pricing, portfolios, trust information, requests, proposals, communication, confirmation, completion, and verified reviews.

Intermediation becomes especially useful when customers face many possible choices, which is a defining feature of beauty-service discovery.

How Lumina Creates Value

Value for Clients

- Easier discovery
- Clearer comparison
- More transparent pricing and service information
- Better trust signals
- Less fragmented searching
- More confidence before choosing a professional

Value for Beauty Professionals

- Greater discoverability
- More qualified client interest
- A structured professional presence
- Credible reputation through service history and reviews
- Ability to compete through quality rather than follower count alone
- Ability to keep using existing booking tools

Revenue model to validate

Lumina may eventually create two monetizable forms of value:

****Intermediation value:**** Lumina brings a professional a qualified client and helps the relationship progress. This could support a transaction- or booking-related fee.

****Software and business-tool value:**** Lumina provides professionals with profiles, organization, analytics, visibility, and growth tools. This could support a subscription.

A hybrid model may eventually combine both. This remains a hypothesis—not a decided business model—and should be tested for customer willingness to pay, professional fairness, demand, retention, and sustainable unit economics.

Marketplace Strategy

Local Marketplace Density Matters More Than Feature Count

Keep the points about:

- focused launch area
- small number of strong categories
- complete professional profiles
- responsive professionals
- real completed-request/review history

Adding more features will not compensate for weak local supply or low client demand.

Strategic Positioning

Recommended working position

> Lumina is a beauty discovery and trust platform that helps clients compare independent professionals with clarity before they commit—and helps professionals build credible discovery without replacing the tools they already use.

Strategic Positioning Priorities

- Clarity before commitment
- Confidence in choosing the right professional
- Real work, transparent information, and verified service history
- Professional quality rather than follower count alone
- Flexible requests for services that require conversation
- Credibility for talented independent and newer professionals

Strategic Boundaries

What Lumina should not claim yet

- That it is the largest or most trusted marketplace
- That its reviews are uniquely verified across the industry
- That it will automatically produce new clients
- That it replaces complete salon-management software
- That a final monetization model has been proven

Potential Defensibility

Lumina does not currently have a strong defensible moat. Possible future defensibility could come from:

- Dense local supply and demand in selected markets
- A growing history of completed-service relationships and trusted reputation
- High-quality structured portfolio and service data
- Repeat client-professional relationships
- Strong local brand and community partnerships
- A request and consultation workflow that works especially well for independent beauty services
- Better matching or decision support based on real behavior and service outcomes
- Structured beauty preference data
- Consultation and service-outcome history
- Before-and-after result records linked to real services
- Learning from what clients save, request, book, complete, and rate
- Better recommendations based on actual outcomes, not only browsing behavior
- A growing data/network advantage connecting intent → service → result → satisfaction

These advantages must be earned through usage; they cannot be created by product language alone.

05.Private Beta & Validation

Current Market Approach

Lumina is entering a focused private beta rather than attempting a broad public launch immediately.

The initial supply target is five high-quality, active beauty professionals. The purpose is to observe whether professionals understand the value, complete their profiles, respond to requests, return to the platform, and identify real onboarding friction.

Private Beta Goals

- Validate whether beauty professionals will join and maintain profiles
- Validate whether clients understand and trust the platform
- Observe onboarding friction
- Test whether requests actually lead to confirmed appointments
- Learn what creates repeat use
- Identify repeated bugs and UX friction
- Test whether Lumina creates enough value to eventually monetize

Beta Metrics to Track

The private beta should measure:

- Outreach sent
- Professional responses
- Interested professionals
- Accounts created
- Profiles completed
- Requests received
- Returning professionals
- Repeated feedback and friction

Onboarding Metrics:

- signup completion
- profile completion
- time to complete profile
- services added
- portfolio uploaded
- booking/availability setup completed
- points where user asks for help
- percentage who complete onboarding without founder help

Current Evidence / Traction

- professionals invited

- professionals interested
 - accounts created
 - profiles completed
 - requests sent
 - responses
 - confirmations
 - completions
 - verified reviews
 - professionals who return without prompting
-
- proposals sent
 - request completion rate
 - professional response rate
 - confirmation rate
 - service completion rate
 - review rate
 - clients who return without prompting
 - professionals who update their profile after initial setup
 - before/after or Results usage, if you build that feature

Business Questions to Validate

Lumina is not assuming the final business model is already known. The beta should help answer:

1. Is the trust and verified-review system valuable enough to change client behavior?
2. Will professionals complete and maintain a profile without significant assistance?
3. Does Lumina generate useful client inquiries rather than low-intent traffic?
4. Which professional segment feels the strongest need for Lumina?
5. What part of the product creates repeat use?
6. Which future monetization model feels fair to both sides?

Possible future models may include professional subscriptions, premium profile tools, qualified-lead fees, promoted discovery, or booking-related services. These should be tested only after meaningful demand is demonstrated.

Professional Research

Professional interviews

Ask at least five professionals:

1. How do new clients currently find you?
2. Which booking and business tools do you already use?
3. What do those tools do well or poorly?
4. Would you maintain a Lumina profile without replacing your booking system?
5. What proof would make a Lumina lead feel qualified?

6. How do you feel about subscription, lead, and transaction fees?
7. Which part of onboarding feels like unnecessary work?

Client Research

Client interviews

Ask at least five clients:

1. Tell me about the last time you searched for a new beauty professional.
2. Where did you search first?
3. What made you trust or reject someone?
4. Which information was missing or difficult to compare?
5. Did you contact more than one professional?
6. Would you rather request details or instantly book?
7. What would make a "verified" review feel credible?

Avoid asking only whether people "like" Lumina. Ask about recent behavior, actual decisions, frustration, and money already spent.

Competitor walkthroughs

Test at least three direct competitors as both a client and, where practical, a professional. Record:

- Signup time
- Profile setup effort
- Search and filtering quality
- Portfolio and pricing clarity
- Review labels and explanation
- Booking or request flow
- Fees shown during the experience
- Whether a professional can keep an outside booking system
- Confusing or surprisingly good moments

Assumption & Validation Tracker

Use this section to separate facts from assumptions.

What we believe	What we know right now	Confidence	How we test it
Clients worry about choosing the wrong beauty professional	This comes from the founder's observations, but we have not confirmed it	Low	Interview at least 5 clients about the last time they

What we believe	What we know right now	Confidence	How we test it
Professionals want more discovery without replacing their current booking tools	through enough client interviews yet This is part of Lumina's current strategy, but professionals have not validated it yet	Low	searched for a beauty professional Interview at least 5 beauty professionals
A request-first process may work better for custom or consultation-based services	Lumina currently uses this flow, but we do not yet know whether users prefer it	Low	Track which service types successfully move from request → confirmation → completion
Verified reviews may make clients feel more confident	Other beauty platforms use appointment-linked reviews, suggesting trust matters, but we have not measured Lumina's effect yet	Medium	Test whether clients understand and value Lumina's verified-review explanation
Professionals will maintain a Lumina profile in addition to their existing platforms	No real evidence yet	Low	Watch whether beta professionals complete their profiles, update them, and return without being reminded
A hybrid revenue model could work	It makes sense economically, but nobody has shown willingness to pay for it yet	Low	After users experience Lumina's value, ask professionals about subscriptions, booking fees, and other pricing options

Current Priorities

1. Complete production end-to-end testing.
2. Recruit the first private-beta professionals.
3. Observe onboarding without immediately intervening.
4. Record bugs, UX friction, requests, and founder observations separately.
5. Prioritize repeated feedback rather than changing the product for every opinion.
6. Validate client demand and professional retention.

Feedback Requested From Business Reviewers

When reviewing Lumina, please consider:

- Is the value proposition immediately understandable?
- Which audience should Lumina target first?
- What would motivate a professional to join and maintain a profile?

- What would make a client trust Lumina enough to send a request?
- Does the current messaging communicate trust without overpromising?
- What is the most realistic early customer-acquisition approach?
- Which partnerships could help the private beta?
- Which business assumptions appear weak or untested?
- What should Lumina deliberately avoid doing too early?

06. Competitive Analysis

****Last updated:**** August 17, 2026

****Stage:**** Private Beta / Production Testing

****Research type:**** Competitor-owned websites and help centers

Executive Summary

Lumina is entering a mature and competitive beauty-technology market. Booksy, Fresha, StyleSeat, Vagaro, and Square Go already combine professional discovery, profiles, services, prices, booking, and customer reviews. Several explicitly connect reviews to real or completed appointments.

This means ****verified reviews alone are not a unique competitive advantage****.

Lumina's strongest current positioning hypothesis is the combination of:

- Trust-first beauty discovery
- Clear comparison before a client commits
- Portfolio, pricing, location, availability, and reputation in one profile
- A request-and-proposal flow for services that need conversation or custom details
- Completion-linked verified reviews
- The ability for professionals to keep using their existing booking tools
- A focused, premium experience for independent beauty professionals

Lumina should not compete head-on as a full salon operating system during private beta. The immediate opportunity is to determine whether clients and independent professionals value a clearer, more trustworthy decision layer before booking.

Market Categories

Direct marketplace competitors

These platforms help clients discover and book beauty or wellness professionals:

- Booksy
- Fresha
- StyleSeat
- Vagaro
- Square Go / Square Appointments

Professional software competitors

These products primarily help professionals operate, market, schedule, and manage their businesses:

- GlossGenius
- Square Appointments
- Vagaro
- Fresha
- Booksy

Existing customer substitutes

These are not identical products, but they already solve part of the problem for clients:

- Instagram and TikTok for visual discovery
- Google and Yelp for local search and reviews
- Facebook groups and local community pages
- Personal referrals and word of mouth
- Individual professional websites and booking links

The most important competitive question is not only, "Why Lumina instead of Booksy?" It is also, "Why would someone use Lumina instead of Instagram, Google, a referral, and an existing booking link?"

Competitive Snapshot

Platform	What it Mainly Does	Marketplace Discovery	Appointment-Linked Reviews	Why It Matters to Lumina
Booksy	Booking marketplace + business-management tools	Yes	Yes	Strong discovery, booking, pricing, portfolios, reviews, and professional tools
Fresha	Beauty/wellness marketplace + salon-management platform	Yes	Yes	Strong discovery plus instant booking, payments, marketing, and salon operations
StyleSeat	Beauty-professional discovery + booking	Yes	Yes	Beauty-focused marketplace with established client

Platform	What it Mainly Does	Marketplace Discovery	Appointment-Linked Reviews	Why It Matters to Lumina
Vagaro	Beauty/wellness marketplace + business software	Yes	Yes	discovery and professional growth tools Strong local discovery with scheduling, payments, forms, reviews, and management tools
Square Go	Beauty marketplace connected to Square Appointments	Yes	Yes	Benefits from Square's large seller network, payments, booking infrastructure, and brand recognition
GlossGenius	Branded booking + business-management software	Limited	Not a main marketplace feature	Strong professional branding, booking websites, payments, and marketing tools, but less focused on broad marketplace comparison

Pricing snapshot

Pricing changes frequently and must be rechecked before using it in an investor, partner, or public presentation.

Platform	Basic Pricing Model	Current Pricing Snapshot	Extra Marketplace / New-Client Fee
Booksy	Monthly subscription	\$29.99/month for 1 user; +\$20 per additional user	Optional Boost: 30% of a new Boost client's first visit
Fresha	Monthly subscription	\$19.95/month for Independent; \$14.95 per bookable team member for Team	One-time 20% fee for a marketplace-sourced new client, subject to a minimum
StyleSeat	Marketplace/new-client fees	No base subscription listed in this snapshot	30% of the first appointment from New Client Connection; client booking fee listed as \$2.35
Vagaro	Monthly subscription	Limited-time U.S. base price shown as \$23.99/month for 1 bookable calendar	Additional calendars cost extra

Platform	Basic Pricing Model	Current Pricing Snapshot	Extra Marketplace / New-Client Fee
Square Go	Free marketplace + broader Square ecosystem	Square Go described as free for clients and businesses	Square earns through paid Square tools and payment processing
GlossGenius	Tiered monthly subscription	Plans begin at \$28/month	Higher Gold, Platinum, and practice tiers available

What the Research Changes for Lumina

1. Verified reviews are necessary, but not sufficient

Lumina's completion-linked review protection is an important trust requirement. However, Booksy, Fresha, StyleSeat, Vagaro, and Square Go all promote verified or post-appointment reviews.

Lumina should therefore avoid claims such as:

- "The only platform with verified beauty reviews"
- "Other beauty marketplaces do not verify reviews"

The stronger claim is that Lumina is designing the ****entire decision experience**** around clarity and trust, from discovery through completed-service reputation.

2. Request-first service matching may be a useful wedge

Most major competitors emphasize direct calendar booking. Lumina currently supports a structured request, professional proposal, client confirmation, conversation, external booking continuation, completion, and review flow.

This may be valuable for:

- Custom services that require consultation
- Flexible dates or times
- Mobile and travel-based professionals
- Services whose final price depends on the client's needs
- Professionals who want to accept or shape an appointment before it reaches their calendar

This is a hypothesis to test, not yet a proven advantage.

3. Working with existing tools reduces switching friction

Many professionals already use Square, GlossGenius, Booksy, Fresha, or another booking system. Lumina currently allows a professional to continue the client into an existing booking link instead of requiring Lumina to replace the full business system.

That creates a possible early message:

> Build trust and get discovered on Lumina while keeping the booking tools you already use.

The risk is that maintaining another profile may feel like extra work. Private-beta interviews must determine whether the added credibility and discovery are valuable enough to justify that effort.

4. Local marketplace density matters more than feature count

A marketplace is useful only when clients can find enough relevant, active professionals and professionals receive meaningful demand.

Lumina should prioritize:

- A focused launch area
- A small number of strong service categories
- Complete, credible professional profiles
- Responsive professionals
- Real completed-request and review history

Adding more features will not compensate for weak local supply or low client demand.

Lumina's Current Strengths

- Clear trust-oriented product philosophy
- Database-protected request completion and review flow
- Structured professional profiles with portfolio, services, pricing, location, and availability
- Client comparison and saved-professional tools
- Request-linked messaging and notifications
- Flexible proposal flow before booking
- Support for salon, home-studio, mobile-salon, and travel-based professionals
- Ability to coexist with existing professional booking links
- Calm, premium visual direction
- Founder access to early users for close observation

These are product strengths. They are not yet proof of market advantage.

Lumina's Current Weaknesses and Risks

- Very small marketplace supply compared with established competitors
- Limited client awareness and no proven acquisition channel yet
- No integrated calendar, payments, deposits, or no-show protection
- No established history of reviews or repeat transactions
- Professionals may not want to maintain another profile
- Clients may continue directly to social media or an outside booking site
- A request-first flow may feel slower than instant booking for simple services
- Trust positioning may be difficult to communicate without enough completed-service evidence
- Competitors already have significant marketplace, payment, and business-software advantages
- Lumina does not yet have a demonstrated moat

Strategic Conclusion

Lumina should not try to win by having more operating features than Booksy, Fresha, Vagaro, Square, or GlossGenius.

The private-beta goal is to determine whether Lumina can become the clearest and most trusted ****pre-booking decision experience**** for a focused group of clients and independent beauty professionals.

The possible longer-term differentiation path is not simply more booking functionality, but a deeper information layer connecting client inspiration, consultation, actual service outcomes, and future recommendations.

The next competitive advantage should come from evidence:

1. Recruit credible professionals in one focused market.
2. Observe whether they complete and maintain profiles.
3. Watch real clients compare and send requests.
4. Measure confirmation, completion, review, and return behavior.
5. Learn which part of the trust lifecycle users value enough to return for.

Research Limitation

Most current findings above come from competitor-owned sources, which naturally present each company positively. Customer complaints, switching behavior,

satisfaction, and local market performance still need independent interviews, hands-on testing, and review analysis before making major strategy or pricing decisions.

Official Sources

Competitor facts and pricing in this document were checked against official company materials on August 17, 2026:

- [Booksy Marketplace] (<https://biz.booksy.com/en-ie/features/marketplace>)
- [Booksy U.S. pricing] (<https://biz.booksy.com/pricing>)
- [Fresha Marketplace] (<https://www.fresha.com/en-GB/for-business/features/marketplace>)
- [Fresha pricing] (<https://www.fresha.com/pricing>)
- [Fresha review and discovery guidance] (<https://www.fresha.com/en-GB/for-business/salon/getting-discovered-through-the-fresha-marketplace>)
- [StyleSeat overview] (<https://help.styleseat.com/articles/13612632-what-is-styleseat>)
- [StyleSeat New Client Connection] (<https://help.styleseat.com/articles/13612640-get-bookings-on-autopilot-with-new-client-connection>)
- [StyleSeat client pricing] (<https://help.styleseat.com/articles/13612675-how-much-does-styleseat-cost>)
- [Vagaro Marketplace] (<https://www.vagaro.com/pro/marketplace>)
- [Vagaro pricing] (<https://www.vagaro.com/pro/pricing>)
- [Square Go marketplace] (<https://squareup.com/us/en/appointments/square-go>)
- [Square Appointments pricing] (<https://squareup.com/us/en/appointments/pricing>)
- [GlossGenius pricing] (<https://support.glossgenius.com/en/articles/189-glossgenius-pricing-and-subscription-plans>)

07. Brand Guide

This guide is the source of truth for how Lumina should sound, look, and feel.

Brand Name and Meaning

****Lumina**** comes from the idea of light.

Light represents clarity, confidence, beauty, trust, and discovery. Lumina exists to help people confidently discover beauty professionals they can trust.

Official Tagline

****Clarity before you commit.****

The tagline expresses Lumina's role in the beauty journey: helping clients understand their options and feel confident before choosing a professional or booking a service.

Brand Promise

Lumina helps people confidently discover and choose beauty professionals they can trust.

Choosing a beauty professional should feel exciting, not stressful. Instead of endlessly scrolling through social media, guessing from incomplete information, or choosing only by price, clients should be able to compare professionals, understand their services and style, see portfolios, and evaluate credible trust signals.

Talented beauty professionals deserve to be discovered for the quality and professionalism of their work—not only because they spend the most on advertising or offer the largest discount.

Lumina builds clarity and trust between clients and beauty professionals before the appointment.

Mission

To make discovering, comparing, and connecting with beauty professionals simple, trustworthy, and beautiful.

Vision

To become the world's most trusted beauty marketplace.

Core Values

- **Simplicity** – Remove confusion and make the next step obvious.
- **Honesty** – Communicate clearly and never exaggerate what Lumina verifies.
- **Confidence** – Help clients and professionals make informed decisions and feel proud of the outcome.
- **Premium Experience** – Create a thoughtful, consistent, and caring experience without using exclusivity or high price as the signal.
- **Community** – Support lasting, respectful relationships between clients and beauty professionals.

Trust is the outcome these values should create.

Brand Personality

Lumina should feel:

- Elegant
- Calm
- Modern
- Trustworthy
- Premium
- Warm
- Feminine but inclusive
- Clean
- Human
- Community-minded

Lumina should never feel:

- Loud or cluttered
- Cold or overly corporate
- Exclusive for the sake of appearing luxurious
- Pushy, manipulative, or sales-heavy
- Confusing or difficult to navigate

Visual Identity

Lumina's visual identity should feel soft and recognizable without becoming overly pink, decorative, or gender-exclusive. Neutral space, silver-gray details, and dark typography should balance the blush accents.

Color System

Core palette

Soft Baby Pink – #FCF6F7

Blush Pink – #F9D8DF

Pearl / Silver Gray – #C8C1BF

Warm Taupe – #6B645F

Ivory – #F6F2EF

Charcoal – #3A2F2F

Usage

- Use Ivory and warm white for primary backgrounds.
 - Use Soft Baby Pink and Blush for gentle emphasis, selected states, branded moments, and soft aura effects.
 - Use Pearl / Silver Gray for logo outlines, subtle borders, and refined neutral accents.
 - Use Warm Taupe and Charcoal for typography, icons, and strong UI contrast.
 - Pink should remain an accent rather than covering every screen.
 - Maintain accessible contrast; softness should never reduce readability.
- A restrained blush aura or blush-to-ivory gradient may be used around the Lumina mark in larger brand moments.

Subtle blush-to-ivory ombré treatments may be used for brand moments such as the logo, icon backgrounds, or featured areas. They should remain restrained and readable.

Typography

Display headings

- Elegant serif
- Current web direction: Georgia, with Times New Roman as a fallback
- Use for major headlines, editorial moments, and selected section titles

Body and interface

- Clean sans-serif
- Preferred web direction: Geist Sans, with Arial and Helvetica as fallbacks
- Use for navigation, forms, buttons, supporting text, and operational interfaces

Typography should feel refined and readable. Avoid using oversized type when it weakens balance, hierarchy, or mobile usability.

Logo System

- Use the ****primary logo**** for intentional brand moments, presentations, and larger footer applications.
- Use the ****wordmark**** in headers and horizontal spaces where clarity matters most.
- Use the ****Lumina mark**** for browser icons, app icons, compact avatars, and small square applications.
- Preserve clear space around every logo variation.
- Do not stretch, recolor, crowd, or place the logo over visually busy imagery.
- The soft blush-and-ivory ombré may support the mark when sufficient contrast is preserved.

Voice & Tone

Lumina communicates with clarity, warmth, and credibility.

Voice characteristics

- Clear, not technical
- Warm, not overly casual
- Confident, not exaggerated
- Helpful, not controlling
- Premium, not pretentious
- Human, not robotic

Writing guidance

- Explain the next step in plain language.
- Use status language that accurately reflects what happened.
- Prefer “beauty professional” as the inclusive default term.
- Use “artist” when it is familiar within a specific service category or existing interface label.
- Never claim that a profile, portfolio, identity, appointment, or review is verified unless Lumina actually performs that verification.
- Describe current capabilities accurately; do not imply that Lumina processes a booking when it currently facilitates discovery, requests, communication, and connection to existing booking tools.

User Experience Promise

Users should feel:

> I understand my options, I know what to do next, and I feel more confident in my decision.

Nothing should feel unnecessarily confusing. Every meaningful interaction should build confidence.

What Lumina Is

Lumina is a beauty discovery and trust platform.

It helps clients discover, compare, request, communicate with, and build confidence in beauty professionals. It helps professionals present credible information, receive qualified interest, and build reputation through completed-service reviews.

Lumina works alongside the professional tools and booking systems people already use.

What Lumina Is Not

Lumina is not social media.

Lumina is not currently a full salon-management or native booking system.

Lumina is not a luxury product defined by high prices or exclusivity.

Premium is not a price point. It is the feeling created by thoughtful design, consistency, simplicity, attention to detail, trustworthy behavior, and customer care.

The Continuing Brand Question

Every major feature, message, and visual decision should answer:

Does this make it easier for someone to trust the right beauty professional?

08. Long-term Product Vision

Think this section before legal/operations section

The Expansion Thesis

Lumina begins as a beauty discovery and trust marketplace, helping clients confidently find, compare, and connect with beauty professionals.

Overtime, Lumina may expand beyond discovery into a broader trust and operating layer for beauty services. Beauty appointments often involve consultation, expectations, service history, photos, aftercare, policies, communication, and sometimes disagreements. Today, much of this information is fragmented across conversations, social media, booking systems, phones, and memory.

Lumina could eventually organize these interactions into a clearer shared service record for both clients and professionals. This is a long-term product hypothesis, not a commitment to build these capabilities during the current private beta.

Problem Beyond Discovery

Insight I came up with:

- Important instructions are often communicated verbally.
- Clients and professionals may remember conversations differently.
- Before/after photos may be scattered across phones and social media.
- Service history may not follow a client between appointments or professionals.
- Consultation details and agreed expectations may not be documented clearly.
- Professionals who are technically skilled may still struggle to communicate everything consistently.
- When something goes wrong, both parties may lack a clear timeline of what was discussed and performed.

Long-Term Value Proposition

For Clients

- Clearer expectations before a service
- Easier access to relevant service history
- Organized photos and aftercare
- Better understanding of what was agreed upon
- Less confusion if a problem occur

For Professionals

- More consistent consultations
- Better service documentation
- Organized before/ after records
- Easier portfolio management
- Clearer records of instructions and aftercare
- Reduced operational confusion and "you said/I said" disputes

Product Principle

Create clarity before conflict.

The professional should not have to manage everything manually.

Then:

Lumina should take messy real-world activity- photos, messages appointments, consultation notes, service history-and quietly turn into something organized and professional.

*Strong long-term product principle

Possible Product Evolution

Now

Discovery + trust + profiles + requests + communication

Next

Improve booking workflow + completed appointments + verified reputation + easier portfolio management

Later

Consultations + service records + before/after documentation + agreed policies + aftercare

Much later

Client beauty history + deeper professional business tools + structured service recovery/dispute records + intelligent assistance

Note:

MVP discipline: Lumina should not build the later layers until the current marketplace proves that clients and professionals want the core discovery, trust, and connection experience.

Beauty Intent & Outcome Intelligence

Lumina may eventually understand not only what a client browses or saves, but how those preferences connect to real beauty-service decisions and outcomes.

Potential inputs could include:

- saved styles
- viewed results
- searches
- requested services
- consultation preferences
- past completed services
- before-and-after results
- client feedback
- repeat behavior

The goal would not be simply to recommend attractive images. The goal would be to better understand beauty intent and help translate that intent into clearer professional matching, consultation, and future decisions.

Inspiration → Consultation → Agreement → Service → Result → Feedback → Better Future Recommendations

What the client wanted → who performed it → what was agreed → what was done → what the result looked like → whether the client liked it